

Week 9

Data Policies, Compliance, and Organisational Best Practices

- Course; Certificate IV Information Technology - Data Science and AI
- Institution; North Metropolitan TAFE, East Perth Campus
- Delivery; Face-to-face, hands-on learning

Learning Objectives

- Recognise the importance of organisational data policies
- Understand key compliance needs and workplace expectations
- Identify risk management strategies in data handling
- Prepare to review and evaluate real-world data handling policies

Agenda

- Why organisations need data policies
- Review of typical policy components
- Compliance; ethics and legal drivers
- Handling risk and best practices
- Industry examples and a case study
- Activity; preparing for a policy review
- Assessment links and next steps

Introduction

Organisational Data Policies in Practice

- Growing reliance on large datasets and AI raises data handling risks
- Clear data policies help ensure consistent, lawful, and ethical practice
- Links directly to workplace performance and compliance obligations

What is a Data Policy?

- A formal document setting rules for data collection, storage, use, and sharing
- Defines staff roles and responsibilities for handling data securely
- Aligns business processes with legal and ethical requirements

Components of an Effective Data Policy

- Purpose and scope of policy
- Roles and responsibilities across teams
- Data classification and privacy rules
- Security controls and versioning processes
- Procedures for data access and sharing

Real-World Organisational Examples

- TechCorp; AI project policy for data privacy, bias review, and transparency
- University AI Lab; Data documentation, reproducibility, and audit trails
- FinanceStart; Policy on personal data; GDPR-aligned, strict access controls

Why Compliance Matters

- Compliance drives trust with clients and partners
- Failure to comply with laws or ethical standards exposes the organisation to fines and reputational risk
- Responsible and ethical data practices are required for sustainable AI deployment

Data Governance and Compliance Essentials

- Privacy laws; e.g. Australian Privacy Principles, GDPR
- Documentation standards; audit trails for every data handling step
- Regular compliance checks and training required

Managing Data Risk

- Identify risks; accidental disclosure, data loss, or misuse
- Controls; access permissions, data encryption, regular backups
- Monitor compliance through audits and documentation

Policies in Action

- Documented workflows and storage procedures reduce human error
- Clear processes for data access and update requests
- Policy review includes audit-readiness checks for all data projects

Industry Case Study; Large-Scale AI Data Project

- OpenAI used strict data policy for LLM dataset collection
- Procedures included; source validation, contributor guidelines, and bias audits
- Outcome; transparent methodology and public confidence in results

Activity

Prepare to Review a Data Policy

- Read a sample organisational data policy (provided in class)
- Identify key sections covering compliance and risk management
- List questions you would ask in a workplace policy review

Assessment Preparation

- Next report; evaluate how real-world policies support ethical and compliant data use
- Focus on legal compliance, documentation, and risk controls
- Review recent weeks on documenting workflows and bias detection

Building Continuity

- Week 6; assessed data quality and identified bias
- Week 7; practised cleaning and preparing datasets for compliance
- Week 8; built versioned, documented workflows as required in organisational policy
- Week 10; apply policy knowledge to real data analysis tasks

Summary and Next Steps

- Organisational data policies ensure ethical and lawful data use
- Effective compliance and risk management are workplace fundamentals
- Prepare by reviewing a sample policy before our next session on data analysis in practice

